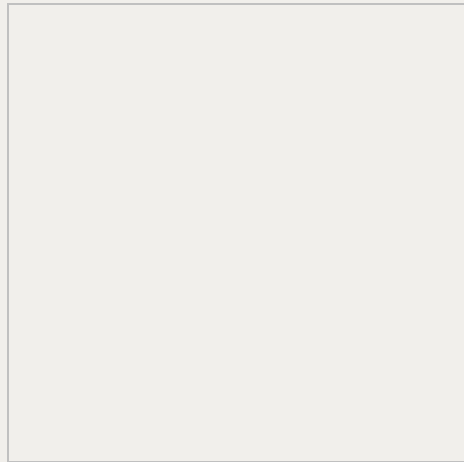


## IN PROFILE

### Lorenzo da Ponte

The librettist for three of Mozart's finest operas, da Ponte was born of Jewish parents in Venice in 1749. After converting to Catholicism, he was ordained a priest in 1773 and became a poet. By 1785, when he first worked with Mozart, he held a post at the imperial court in Vienna. In total, he wrote the libretti for 28 operas by 11 composers, including Mozart. In the 1790s, he migrated first to Britain and then to the US. Settled in New York, he became the first professor of Italian literature at Columbia College and opened the city's first opera house. He died in New York in 1838.



LORENZO DA PONTE, 1759

## Late works

When Leopold Mozart died in May 1787, Wolfgang's compositional powers were at their peak. The three great symphonies he wrote in the summer of 1788 (Nos. 39, 40, and